

DAY 6: SAVE BIG AT THE PUMP

As someone who enjoys routine and stability, fluctuating gas prices and I do not mix. Sometimes it spikes over \$3 a gallon, while the next month we're seeing prices well under \$2—often with no rhyme or reason besides a trending political news story.

I realize these prices are still pretty decent in America compared to other countries, but I think we can all agree there's a huge emotional component tied to watching gas prices dip and soar. Lack of consistency also means gas is difficult to budget for each month. Sure, we have other variable expenses, like groceries or clothing, that fluctuate depending on needs, but their semi-dependable pricing is much easier to plan around than fuel. This month, \$150 in gas *may* be enough to get you where you need to go...next month, maybe not.

But until we find another resource to fuel our vehicles, or electric cars become more mainstream, there's not much we can do to prevent this painful purchase. Even though our world is more closely connected via technology than ever before, we don't all live in a metropolitan area within walking distance of our favorite stores. Nor do we always have the means to take advantage of public transportation like the subway, train, or the latest trendy obsession, Uber.

We *do*, however, have the power to maximize how far we travel on one tank of gas, and believe it or not, even control the price at which we fill up.

Here's how to drive further for much less, and make that tank last as long as possible!

1. STAY HOME

Seems like a no-brainer, but how many of us find an excuse to “run to the store” for “one quick thing”? As someone who works from home, I know how hard it is to be cooped up inside all day, but I also know the length between fill-ups increases substantially when you avoid an outing.